replaced by modern technology and agricultural practices in India. Initially the new technology was tried in 1960-61 as a pilot project in seven districts. It was called as the High Yielding Varieties Programme (HYVP).

Achievement of Green Revolution

(i) The major achievement of the new strategy was to boost the production of major cereals viz., wheat and rice. India was depending on the US for the food grain. The US by using Public Law 480 (PL480) exported wheat to India. Indians were waiting for the ships to sip their food. On the other hand, India has lots of minerals. The US could strategically exploit Indian mineral resources at cheapest price for manufacturing missiles and weapons, which gave job opportunity for larger US youth and largely contributed to US GDP. But now India is food surplus, exporting food grains to the European countries.

(ii) The Green revolution was confined only to High Yielding Varieties (HYV) cereals, mainly rice, wheat, maize and jowar.

(iii) This Strategy was also directed to increase the production of commercial crops or cash crops such as sugarcane, cotton, jute, oilseeds and potatoes.

(iv) Per hectare productivity of all crops had increased due to better seeds.

(v) Green Revolution had positive effect on development of industries, which manufactured agricultural tools like tractors, engines, threshers and pumping sets.

(vi) Green Revolution had brought prosperity to rural people. Increased production had generated employment opportunities for rural masses. Due to this, their standard of living had increased.

(vii) Due to multiple cropping and more use of chemical fertilizers, the demand for labour increased.

(viii) Financial resources were provided by banks and co-operative societies. These banks provided loans to farmers on easy terms.

The New Agricultural strategy was also called by various names. Modern agricultural technology, seed – fertilizer – water technology, or simply green revolution.

Weaknesses of Green Revolution

(i) Indian Agriculture was still a gamble of the monsoons.

(ii) This strategy needed heavy investment in seeds, fertilizers, pesticides and water.

(iii) The income gap between large, marginal and small farmers had increased. Gap between irrigated and rain fed areas had widened.

(iv) Except in Punjab, and to some extent in Haryana, farm mechanization had created

Chapter-08.indd 172 20-02-2020 12:04:00